TAKING THE MIC

Youtuber **Bhuvan Bam** on his latest act as commentator for the game show *Takeshi's Castle* and life since his OTT debut, *Taaza Khabar*



Q. Youtuber, actor and now a voice actor. How challenging was dubbing for the game show *Takeshi's Castle*?
On Instagram, I used to do dubbing, so I am familiar with it. The challenge was to write the entire show, record something and not find it funny a week later. The first episode took me two months to finish. When you work with a platform [Amazon Prime], a lot of legalities are involved. So you work under a restrictive umbrella and have to be creative.

Q. It's quite a cult show with a devoted fanbase. What is its inherent appeal?
We love to see people fail. We enjoy it, especially when they are falling. There's that cult gag of slipping on a banana peel. With *Takeshi*'s, the participants have signed up to be part of the gag.

Q. How has life changed post *Taaza Khabar*, your streaming debut? Did more opportunities come your way?
Not to the extent I had imagined. I still have the [YouTube] creator tag, which takes time to go away. The payback of this show will not be immediate. It's good for me because I am getting to work on second seasons of *Dhindora* and *Taaza Khabar*. *BB Ki Vines* is working on developing seven projects. I am reading many scripts.

Q. So one has to wait for Bhuvan Bam the film star?
No. In the 10-plus scripts, one did appeal to me. I was always keen on being part of a project where I don't have to think what happens if the shoot gets extended and the costs exceed, which is what all I'd discuss on set with two of my business partners.

with Suhani Singh